

No Finite Separable Representation at Three Prime Generators

Nonsingular minors of every order, two-prime Hecke–Mahler polynomials, and the open boundary for Erdős Problem #269

WILL COOK*

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ABSTRACT

For three distinct primes, the reciprocal running-LCM kernel has nonsingular minors of every order, with the same indices in every third-coordinate layer. Diagonal rescaling leaves a binary floor carry whose threshold columns determine every finite sampled rank. This rules out finite exact separation of the kernel, not rationality of its sum. For the repeated $\{2, 3, 5\}$ series, we give the literal integral tail recurrence, a quadratic bound, exact denominator clearing and a residue criterion equivalent to irrationality. We do not prove the required cofinal escape. The two-prime comparison reproduces the earlier Hecke–Mahler reduction attributed to Steve Fan and distinguishes the repeated and distinct-height values. A concrete moving-boundary example explains why quadratic coefficient growth does not by itself yield finite-difference cancellation.

1 Introduction

Let P be a finite set of at least two primes and let $\mathcal{S}_P$ be the positive integers supported on P , including 1. All sums below retain multiplicity unless explicitly marked distinct-height. Put

$$L(x) = \text{lcm}\{u \in \mathcal{S}_P : u \leq x\}, \quad \mathcal{R}_P = \sum_{u \in \mathcal{S}_P} L(u)^{-1}.$$

The historical question is whether $\mathcal{R}_P$ is irrational [1, p. 65][2, p. 106]. We address the repeated series, not the distinct-height assertion recorded by Erdős in his earlier letter [3]. For $P = \{p, q, r\}$, define

$$H(x) = p^{\lfloor \log_p x \rfloor} q^{\lfloor \log_q x \rfloor} r^{\lfloor \log_r x \rfloor}, \quad K(i, j, k) = H(p^i q^j r^k)^{-1}.$$

Prime-power divisibility gives $L = H$ (Proposition 4.1). The supplied forum record credits Steve Fan’s post of 26 June 2026 with this identity for every finite prime set and the two-prime factorisation, reduction and transcendence conclusion [7]. We retain that attribution; the live thread was not accessible during this revision.

**Authorship and AI use.* Will Cook built and directed the research infrastructure and reviewed the claims when he could. AI agents did most of the research and drafting. Cook did not independently verify every claim.

With two primes, the corresponding kernel factors into a function of each exponent separately, reducing the double sum to a product. The first question at three primes is whether finitely many such products still suffice. Theorem 2.1 rules this out: one floor carry survives after all row and column factors have been removed. The proof uses only this rescaling, the density of the rotations by $\log_r p$ and $\log_r q$ taken separately, and a staircase determinant, and one choice of indices serves every third-coordinate layer. We first explain that obstruction, then recover the two-prime comparison, and finally identify the arithmetic of the actual three-prime tails. The last step is necessary because the rank of a kernel does not determine the irrationality of its sum.

Literature and scope. Fixed-prime semigroups and their neighbouring elements are classical objects; see Tijdeman–Meijer [15] and the recent two-prime study of Languasco, Luca, Moree and Togbé [16]. No asymptotic counting theorem from those works is needed for our elementary shell bounds. Kovač–Tao [17] concerns neighbouring irrationality problems for distinct unit fractions, not this repeated-height sum. The rank theorem below concerns equality of kernels with arbitrary rational-valued separated factors. It does not exclude a different analytic representation of the scalar value.

Reading guide. Section 2 proves the representation theorem. The two-prime comparison in Section 3 uses an external value theorem. Sections 4 and 5 define the actual arithmetic quantities and one open target, in equivalent tail and window forms. Source coordinates are collected in Appendix A and the accompanying concordance, not used as substitutes for proofs.

2 The binary carry and arbitrary-order rank

Theorem 2.1 (arbitrary-order non-separability). *Let p, q, r be primes with $p \neq q$, $p \neq r$ and $q \neq r$. For every $n \geq 0$ there are injective maps $I, J : \{0, \dots, n-1\} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$ such that, for every $k \geq 0$,*

$$\det(K(I(a), J(b), k))_{0 \leq a, b < n} \neq 0.$$

Consequently, for no finite d do there exist rational-valued functions $f_\ell(i)$ and $G_\ell(j, k)$, $0 \leq \ell < d$, satisfying

$$K(i, j, k) = \sum_{\ell < d} f_\ell(i) G_\ell(j, k) \quad \text{for all } i, j, k.$$

Proof. Put $c = r^{-1}$, $x_i = \{i \log_r p\}$ and $y_j = \{j \log_r q\}$. Splitting the floor exponents gives

$$K(i, j, k) = U_i(k)^{-1} C_{ij} V_j(k)^{-1}, \quad C_{ij} = c^{\mathbf{1}_{\{x_i + y_j \geq 1\}}},$$

where

$$U_i(k) = p^i q^{\lfloor \log_q(p^i r^k) \rfloor} r^{k + \lfloor \log_r p^i \rfloor},$$

$$V_j(k) = q^j p^{\lfloor \log_p(q^j r^k) \rfloor} r^{\lfloor \log_r q^j \rfloor}.$$

Both factors are positive. Distinct primes make $\log_r p$ and $\log_r q$ irrational, so each individual rotation is dense. No joint density of (x_i, y_j) is needed. For $n \geq 1$, use density of (x_i) to choose distinct row indices with $0 < x_{I(0)} < \dots < x_{I(n-1)} < 1$. Now put $s_b = 1 - y_{J(b)}$. Density of (y_j) lets us choose

$$s_0 \in (0, x_{I(0)}), \quad s_b \in (x_{I(b-1)}, x_{I(b)}) \quad (1 \leq b < n).$$

The intervals for the s_b are disjoint, so the column indices are distinct. The strict inequalities also avoid the threshold itself, and give $x_{I(a)} + y_{J(b)} \geq 1$ exactly when $b \leq a$. Thus multiplying row a by $U_{I(a)}(k)$ and column b by $V_{J(b)}(k)$ reduces the selected kernel minor to

$$T_n(c) = \begin{pmatrix} c & 1 & \cdots & 1 \\ c & c & \cdots & 1 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ c & c & \cdots & c \end{pmatrix}, \quad \det T_n(c) = c(c-1)^{n-1}.$$

Indeed, subtracting each preceding row from the next, working upwards from the last row, leaves diagonal entries $c, c-1, \dots, c-1$. Before normalisation, the determinant is this nonzero number times

$$\prod_{a < n} U_{I(a)}(k)^{-1} \prod_{b < n} V_{J(b)}(k)^{-1}.$$

The factors are nonzero, and the same I, J work for every k . The empty minor for $n = 0$ equals 1.

For the final assertion, suppose a separation with d summands existed and fix any k . On the rows $I(0), \dots, I(d)$ and columns $J(0), \dots, J(d)$ its matrix would be the product of the $(d+1) \times d$ matrix $(f_\ell(I(a)))_{a,\ell}$ and the $d \times (d+1)$ matrix $(G_\ell(J(b), k))_{\ell,b}$. Its rank would be at most d , so its determinant would vanish, contrary to the minor just constructed. $\square$

Scope of the rank obstruction. The proof works over $\mathbb{R}$ or $\mathbb{C}$ as well as $\mathbb{Q}$: a factorisation through a d -dimensional space still has rank at most d . The displayed theorem retains the rational-valued scope of the supplied formal statement. Also $p \neq q$ is not used by the carry argument itself; it is retained because the running-LCM application has three distinct prime generators.

Corollary 2.2 (the same minors modulo every admissible denominator). *For $(p, q, r) = (2, 3, 5)$ and every $n \geq 1$, there are injective maps $I, J : \{0, \dots, n-1\} \rightarrow \mathbb{N}$, chosen independently of B and k , such that for every $B \geq 2$ coprime to 30 and every $k \geq 0$, the selected $n \times n$ kernel matrix has unit determinant over $\mathbb{Z}/B\mathbb{Z}$, with each reciprocal prime power interpreted by its modular inverse.*

Proof. Choose the maps from Theorem 2.1. Every row and column factor is a unit modulo B . The normalised determinant is $5^{-1}(-4/5)^{n-1}$, also a unit. $\square$

Example 2.3. For $(p, q, r) = (2, 3, 5)$, the leading two-by-two determinant is $-1/15$: its four entries are $1, 1/6, 1/2, 1/60$, so it equals $1/60 - 1/12$.

The indices must be selected. The leading 4×4 block at $\{2, 3, 5\}$ is singular:

$$K(3, j, 0) = \frac{1}{120} K(0, j, 0) \quad (0 \leq j < 4).$$

These equalities follow by evaluating the height at 3^j and $8 \cdot 3^j$. At $j = 4$ the difference is $-1/19440000$. Thus the leading minors do not supply the arbitrary-order theorem.

Proposition 2.4 (finite sampled cut rank). *Let $m \geq 1$ and let c lie in a field with $c \neq 0, 1$. For $0 \leq k \leq m$ write v_k for the length- m column with a 1 in each of the first k coordinates and c thereafter. A matrix whose distinct columns are v_k for k in a nonempty set E has rank $|E| - \mathbf{1}_{\{0, m\} \subseteq E}$.*

Proof. List $E = \{k_1 < \dots < k_t\}$. The $t - 1$ differences $v_{k_{j+1}} - v_{k_j} = (1 - c)\mathbf{1}_{\{k_j, \dots, k_{j+1}-1\}}$ have disjoint nonempty supports, hence are linearly independent. If $k_1 > 0$ or $k_t < m$, their union misses a coordinate where v_{k_1} is nonzero, so the rank is t . If $k_1 = 0$ and $k_t = m$, then $v_0 = c\mathbf{1}$ lies in the span of the differences (their sum is $(1 - c)\mathbf{1}$), so the rank is $t - 1$. $\square$

After ordering the sampled row phases, the columns have exactly the forms v_k above; repeated rows or columns add no rank. Thus the formula classifies every nonempty finite sample after diagonal rescaling, uniformly in the third coordinate. It also gives an exact algorithm: order the rationals $p^i / r^{\lfloor \log_r p^i \rfloor}$, count those strictly below $r^{\lfloor \log_r q^j \rfloor + 1} / q^j$, and apply the endpoint correction. Integer comparisons suffice; no floating-point decision at a threshold is needed.

The norm matters. For the infinite normalised carry matrix,

$$\inf_{F \text{ of finite separated rank}} \|C - F\|_\infty = (1 - c)/2.$$

For $c = 1/r$, distinct columns are exactly $1 - c$ apart in the supremum norm. An error $\varepsilon < (1 - c)/2$ would place the approximating columns in a bounded subset of their finite-dimensional span, with pairwise distance at least $1 - c - 2\varepsilon > 0$. Such a subset is totally bounded, a contradiction. This argument uses bounded columns, not bounded individual factors in a separated expression. The constant $(1 + c)/2$ attains the bound.

Finite restrictions have a different behaviour. At $c = 1/5$,

$$T = \begin{pmatrix} 1/5 & 1 \\ 1/5 & 1/5 \end{pmatrix}, \quad A = \begin{pmatrix} 3/10 & 9/10 \\ 1/10 & 3/10 \end{pmatrix}$$

satisfy $\det A = 0$ and $\|T - A\|_{\max} = 1/10 < 2/5$. For the original three-index kernel, put $K^{(N)}(i, j, k) = \mathbf{1}_{\{i < N\}} K(i, j, k)$. This has separated rank at most N across $i \mid (j, k)$, and the $\ell^1(\mathbb{N}^3)$ error satisfies

$$\|K - K^{(N)}\|_{\ell^1} \leq \frac{pqr p^{-3N}}{(1 - p^{-3})(1 - q^{-3})(1 - r^{-3})}.$$

This follows from $H(x) > x^3/(pqr)$. Thus the infinite uniform obstruction coexists with geometric approximation in the summation norm. The scalar irrationality question requires arithmetic information about the actual multiplicities.

3 The two-prime comparison

For distinct primes $p < q$, write $L_{p,q}(t) = p^{\lfloor \log_p t \rfloor} q^{\lfloor \log_q t \rfloor}$. Prime-power divisibility identifies this product with the running LCM. Let $\mathcal{R}_{p,q}$ retain every smooth-number multiplicity, and let $\mathcal{D}_{p,q}$ retain the initial value and one reciprocal at each positive pure-power

jump. Fan's forum post gives the repeated two-prime factorisation and its quadratic reduction to a single Hecke–Mahler value, and the same boundary-channel calculation yields the de-duplicated affine formula displayed below [7]. We give the calculation to fix normalisations and to distinguish repeated from distinct-height sums.

Theorem 3.1 (both two-prime sums). *Let $p < q$ be distinct primes. Put $\theta = \log p / \log q$ and $A = \sum_{n \geq 0} p^{-n} q^{-\lfloor n\theta \rfloor}$. Let $\mathcal{R}_{p,q}$ sum the reciprocal running LCM at every positive $\{p, q\}$ -smooth integer, and let $\mathcal{D}_{p,q}$ count each distinct running LCM once. Then*

$$\mathcal{D}_{p,q} = \frac{(q-p)A + p}{q-1}, \quad \mathcal{R}_{p,q} = \frac{(p+q-1)A - (p-1)A^2}{q-1}. \quad (1)$$

Both numbers are transcendental.

Proof. Set $x = 1/p$, $y = 1/q$, $m_n = \lfloor n\theta \rfloor$ and $\delta_n = m_{n+1} - m_n$. Unique factorisation makes θ irrational, and $0 < \theta < 1$ gives $\delta_n \in \{0, 1\}$. The initial value and the p -channel contribute $A = \sum_{n \geq 0} x^n y^{m_n}$. There is one q -power between p^n and p^{n+1} precisely when $\delta_n = 1$, so the other channel contributes

$$B = \sum_{n \geq 0} \delta_n x^n y^{m_{n+1}}, \quad \mathcal{D}_{p,q} = A + B.$$

All these series converge absolutely. Since $y^{m_{n+1}} - y^{m_n} = \delta_n y^{m_n} (y - 1)$, shifting the series for A gives $A - 1 - xA = x(y - 1)B/y$. Therefore

$$B = \frac{p - (p-1)A}{q-1}.$$

At $p^i q^j$ the height is $p^{i+\lfloor j/\theta \rfloor} q^{j+m_i}$, hence

$$\mathcal{R}_{p,q} = A \sum_{j \geq 0} y^j x^{\lfloor j/\theta \rfloor} = A(1 + B).$$

For the last equality, each $j \geq 1$ corresponds to $n = \lfloor j/\theta \rfloor$ with $m_n = j - 1$ and $\delta_n = 1$. These identities prove (1).

For the Hecke–Mahler series $F_\theta(x, y) = \sum_{n \geq 1} \sum_{k=1}^{m_n} x^n y^k$, geometric summation gives

$$A = \frac{1}{1-x} - \frac{1-y}{y} F_\theta(x, y). \quad (2)$$

Bugeaud and Laurent's theorem [5, Theorem 1.1] applies with intercept $\rho = 0$, $\beta = x$ and $\alpha = y$: the slope θ is irrational and lies in $(0, 1)$, x and y are nonzero algebraic numbers, $|x| < 1$ and $|xy^\theta| = p^{-2} < 1$. Hence $F_\theta(x, y)$ is transcendental; this case $\rho = 0$ is due to Loxton and van der Poorten [6, Theorem 8, p. 40]. Thus A is transcendental. The displayed affine and quadratic polynomials are nonconstant, so an algebraic value of either would force A to be algebraic. $\square$

The two-prime reduction expresses both sums through one value. The third prime leaves the binary carry of Section 2. Its rank theorem concerns that function; the scalar arithmetic depends on the multiplicities introduced next. The de-duplicated irrationality assertion is historical [3].

4 Exact multiplicities and normalised tails

Proposition 4.1 (the running least common multiple). *Let p, q, r be pairwise distinct primes and $x \geq 1$. Then the running LCM equals the three-prime height: $L(x) = H(x)$.*

Proof. Every smooth $n \leq x$ has prime exponents bounded by the corresponding integer logarithms, so $n \mid H(x)$. Conversely the three maximal pure powers occur among those smooth numbers; their product divides the running LCM because they are pairwise coprime. $\square$

The inequalities $x/p < p^{\lfloor \log_p x \rfloor} \leq x$ for each of the three primes also give

$$x^3/(pqr) < H(x) \leq x^3. \quad (3)$$

Proposition 4.2 (cells and jumps). *The running LCM is constant when the three integer logarithms are constant. A jump in exactly one logarithm multiplies it by the corresponding prime. The first n positive powers in each channel, together with 1, form $3n + 1$ distinct points.*

Proof. The first two claims follow from the height formula. Positive powers from different prime channels cannot coincide, by unique factorisation, and none is 1. $\square$

Proposition 4.3 (height-fibre regrouping). *For a finite exponent box $\mathcal{B}$, set $F(H) = \{(i, j, k) \in \mathcal{B} : H(p^i q^j r^k) = H\}$. Then*

$$\sum_{(i,j,k) \in \mathcal{B}} K(i, j, k) = \sum_H \frac{\#F(H)}{H}. \quad (4)$$

Proof. Each term in $F(H)$ equals $1/H$. The multiplicities remain present in every subsequent infinite sum. $\square$

From now on let $P = \{2, 3, 5\}$ and $S = \mathcal{R}_P$. For $a \geq 0$ define

$$s_a = \sum_{\substack{x \text{ smooth} \\ 2^a \leq x < 2^{a+1}}} \frac{1}{H(x)}, \quad T_a = \sum_{j \geq 0} s_{a+j}, \quad h_a = \frac{H(2^a)}{2}, \quad X_a = h_a T_a.$$

Thus T_a is the raw tail, X_a its normalised state, and $P_a := H(2^a) = 2h_a$. In particular $h_0 = 1/2$, while h_a is a positive integer for $a \geq 1$. The literal radix and forcing numerator are

$$b_a = \frac{H(2^{a+1})}{H(2^a)}, \quad m_a = \sum_{\substack{x \text{ smooth} \\ 2^a \leq x < 2^{a+1}}} \frac{H(2^{a+1})}{2H(x)}. \quad (5)$$

Lemma 4.4 (integer forcing and the four radices). *For every $a \geq 0$, m_a is a positive integer and $b_a \in \{2, 6, 10, 30\}$. The word “numerator” does not impose the positional-digit restriction $m_a < b_a$; that restriction need not hold.*

Proof. If $x < 2^{a+1}$, the two-exponent of $H(x)$ is at most a , while the other exponents are bounded by those of $H(2^{a+1})$. Hence $2H(x) \mid H(2^{a+1})$. Each forcing summand is an integer, and the shell contains 2^a . Between consecutive two-powers there is at most one three-power and at most one five-power: two successive powers in either channel have ratio strictly greater than two. Their optional factors, together with the terminal factor two, give the four radices. $\square$

Since $h_{a+1} = b_0 b_1 \cdots b_a / 2$, the value $S/2 = \sum_{a \geq 0} m_a / (b_0 b_1 \cdots b_a)$ is a Cantor series and $X_a = \sum_{j \geq a} m_j / (b_a \cdots b_j)$ is its normalised tail. Such tails, with their integer carry recurrence, are the classical tool for the rationality of Cantor series. Erdős and Straus characterise rationality by integer carries [8, Theorem 2.1 and (2.4), pp. 85–86], and Hančl and Tijdeman give a practical form of that criterion through the tails [9, §§2–3 and Theorem 3.1, pp. 372–375]. Both criteria assume that the n th numerator is $o(a_{n-1} a_n)$, where a_n is the n th base. Here $m_a \geq 1$ and $b_{a-1} b_a \leq 900$, so the recurrence, the bound and the denominator clearing below are proved directly for this series. The polynomial criterion of Hančl–Tijdeman [12, Theorems 2.2 and 3.1] assumes a nonconstant polynomial radix and does not cover this bounded sequence. Their Theorem 4.2 is a separate, more general telescoping principle: it requires an exact finite-product decomposition and a small transformed numerator. Neither a quadratic bound nor a polynomial carry ansatz supplies those hypotheses. The prior Isabelle/HOL formalisation of the classical Erdős–Straus criteria is due to Koutsoukou-Argyarakis and Li [18]; it is not a verification of the present series.

Proposition 4.5 (the actual recurrence and a polynomial bound). *The series defining S, T_a converge. For every $a \geq 0$,*

$$X_{a+1} = b_a X_a - m_a, \quad 0 < X_a \leq \frac{8640}{343} (a+1)^2 < 90(a+1)^2.$$

For every integer $B \geq 1$, either some BX_a is integral and all later states are integral, or $\text{dist}(BX_a, \mathbb{Z}) \geq 1/31$ at arbitrarily large indices.

Proof. A dyadic shell contains at most one two-exponent for each pair of three- and five-exponents. Each of the latter lies between 0 and a , so there are at most $(a+1)^2$ terms. By (3), $s_a \leq 30(a+1)^2/8^a$. Therefore

$$X_a \leq 15(a+1)^2 \sum_{j \geq 0} \frac{(j+1)^2}{8^j} = \frac{8640}{343} (a+1)^2.$$

This proves convergence and the bound. Splitting the first shell gives the recurrence because $m_a = h_{a+1} s_a$ and $h_{a+1} = b_a h_a$. Put $Y_a = BX_a$. If all sufficiently late distances are strictly below $1/31$, write $Y_a = z_a + e_a$ with $z_a \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $|e_a| < 1/31$. Then $e_{a+1} - b_a e_a$ is an integer of absolute value less than one, so $e_{a+1} = b_a e_a$. The factors $b_a \geq 2$ force a bounded such error to be zero. An integral state propagates by the integer recurrence. $\square$

The window criterion needs only a valid carry cap; $90B(a+1)^2$ suffices. The long record proves $X_a \leq Q(n_a)$ and the smaller bound $X_a \leq \tilde{Q}(n_a)$, where $n_a = a + \lfloor \log_3 2^a \rfloor + \lfloor \log_5 2^a \rfloor$. It keeps these sharper caps separate from the coarse cap used here.

Theorem 4.6 (actual rationality-to-reduced-carry bridge). *If $S = A/D$ in lowest terms, where $D = 2^u 3^v 5^w B$ and $\gcd(B, 30) = 1$, then for every $a \geq a_0 = u + 1 + 2v + 3w$,*

$$d_a = BX_a \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}, \quad d_{a+1} = b_a d_a - Bm_a, \quad d_a \leq 90B(a+1)^2.$$

Proof. For $a \geq 1$, strict boundary clearing gives

$$X_a = h_a S - Z_a, \quad Z_a = \sum_{\substack{x \text{ smooth} \\ x < 2^a}} \frac{h_a}{H(x)} \in \mathbb{Z}. \quad (6)$$

The two-exponent of h_a is $a - 1$. Moreover $a \geq 2v$ gives $2^a \geq 3^v$, and $a \geq 3w$ gives $2^a \geq 5^w$. Thus $2^u 3^v 5^w \mid h_a$ after the stated onset, and $BX_a = h_a A / (2^u 3^v 5^w) - BZ_a$ is integral. Positivity, the recurrence and the bound follow from Proposition 4.5. $\square$

Corollary 4.7 (the exact clearing onset). *Under the same lowest-terms hypothesis, put $M = 2^u 3^v 5^w$ and let den denote the positive reduced denominator. For $a \geq 1$,*

$$\text{den}(BX_a) = \frac{M}{\gcd(M, h_a)}.$$

Consequently BX_a is integral exactly when $2^a \geq \max(2^{u+1}, 3^v, 5^w)$. The first such a can be found by integer comparisons, without logarithmic rounding.

Proof. Equation (6) gives $BX_a = h_a A / M - BZ_a$. Since $\gcd(A, M) = 1$, reducing that fraction gives the displayed denominator. The three divisibility conditions for h_a are precisely the three inequalities stated above. $\square$

5 A window test and the remaining arithmetic

The actual digits in (5) define

$$W_{\ell,0} = 1, \quad F_{\ell,0} = 0, \quad W_{\ell,h+1} = b_{\ell,h} W_{\ell,h}, \quad F_{\ell,h+1} = b_{\ell,h} F_{\ell,h} + m_{\ell,h}.$$

Induction on h gives

$$X_{\ell+h} = W_{\ell,h} X_\ell - F_{\ell,h}. \quad (7)$$

For integers $W \geq 1$ and t , define $\text{lpr}_W(t) = 1 + ((t - 1) \bmod W)$, using a remainder in $\{0, \dots, W - 1\}$. Thus a zero residue is represented by W , not 0. Throughout this section use the valid cap

$$K(B, a) = 90B(a + 1)^2. \quad (8)$$

Lemma 5.1 (finite endpoint obstruction). *If d is a positive integer with $d \leq K$ and $d \equiv -BF \pmod{W}$, where $W \geq 1$, then $\text{lpr}_W(-BF) \leq K$.*

Proof. Every positive representative of the residue is at least its least positive representative, so $\text{lpr}_W(-BF) \leq d \leq K$. $\square$

Theorem 5.2 (the actual window criterion). *The number S is irrational if and only if*

$$\begin{aligned} &\text{for every } B \geq 1 \text{ with } \gcd(B, 30) = 1 \text{ and every } a_0 \geq 1, \\ &\text{there are } \ell \geq a_0, h \geq 1 \text{ such that } \text{lpr}_{W_{\ell,h}}(-BF_{\ell,h}) > K(B, \ell + h). \end{aligned} \quad (9)$$

Proof. If S is rational, Theorem 4.6 supplies a positive integral carry $d_a = BX_a$ after its onset. Choose a window in (9) beyond that onset. Equation (7) gives $d_{\ell+h} \equiv -BF_{\ell,h} \pmod{W_{\ell,h}}$, contradicting Lemma 5.1 and the valid cap.

Conversely, let S be irrational and fix $B, \ell \geq 1$. Equation (6) makes BX_ℓ nonintegral. Put $\delta = \lceil BX_\ell \rceil - BX_\ell \in (0, 1)$. Since $W_{\ell,h} \geq 2^h$ and $X_{\ell+h} = O((\ell + h + 1)^2)$, for all sufficiently large h the number $\delta + BX_{\ell+h}/W_{\ell,h}$ lies in $(0, 1)$. The window identity then gives the exact equality

$$\text{lpr}_{W_{\ell,h}}(-BF_{\ell,h}) = \delta W_{\ell,h} + BX_{\ell+h}.$$

Its exponentially growing first term eventually exceeds $K(B, \ell + h)$. This proves (9), in fact from each fixed start. $\square$

The validity of the cap is needed in the rational direction; an upper polynomial growth condition by itself would not suffice. The zero cap, for example, makes positive-residue escape automatic. The criterion identifies the target in window coordinates. The unresolved point is the source-specific exclusion below.

Problem 5.3 (the repeated three-prime target). Prove that $S = \mathcal{R}_{\{2,3,5\}}$ is irrational. Equivalently, prove

$$BX_a \notin \mathbb{Z} \quad \text{for every } a \geq 1 \text{ and every } B \geq 1 \text{ coprime to } 30, \quad (10)$$

or prove the cofinal window condition (9).

Indeed, one integral scaled tail makes S rational by (6); conversely, a rational S has such tails after denominator clearing. These are equivalent formulations of one target, not two independent missing hypotheses.

A coefficient obstruction, not a transferred theorem. Luca, Ouaknine and Worrell [13, Definition 5, Theorems 6 and 8, Claim 10] use finite-difference cancellation away from floor crossings, followed by expanding-gap and relative-variation estimates. For our literal numerators, put $\gamma_{a,t} = P_t P_{a+1} / P_{a+t+1}$ and $D_{r,a} = 15 \sum_{j=0}^3 (-1)^j \binom{3}{j} \gamma_{a,jr} m_{a+jr}$. At $a = 0, r = 35$, exact comparisons give $\lfloor \log_3 2^{35\nu} \rfloor = 22\nu$, $\lfloor \log_5 2^{35\nu} \rfloor = 15\nu$ and $b_{35\nu} = 2$ for $0 \leq \nu \leq 3$. These facts together eliminate the relevant floor-addition crossings and make all four corrections 1. Nevertheless

$$D_{35,0} = 15(1 - 3 \cdot 195 + 3 \cdot 723 - 1582) = 45 \neq 0.$$

The long record proves this by exact lattice counts and isolates the uncanceled boundary strips. It refutes automatic cubic cancellation, not every possible operator or an eventual sparse-defect construction.

A fixed-base expansion is not impossible: the direct base-30 recoding has coefficients $e_a = m_a 30^{a+1} / P_{a+1} \in \mathbb{Z}_{>0}$, but $e_a \geq (15/4)^{a+1}$, so it fails the polynomial-growth hypothesis of the cited criterion. The finite-alphabet echoing criterion [14] and the base-expansion complexity theorem [19, Theorem 1] likewise require properties of a value-preserving coefficient or digit sequence, not merely of (b_a) .

A separate distinct-height programme. For $\mathcal{D}_{2,3,5}$, recovering a proof of the historical irrationality assertion or establishing transcendence is a different task. An analytic approach must first construct a specified function and an exact value identity, then verify a published value theorem’s hypotheses. In particular, the multivariate Mahler theory of Adamczewski and Faverjon [20] requires a functional system and suitable evaluation data; having a two-dimensional lattice count is not enough. No such system is established here.

The information the remaining argument must use. The bounded-radix alternative permits the integral branch. If (g_a) is an unbounded sequence of positive integers with bounded successive ratios, the real ξ with $\text{dist}(g_a \xi, \mathbb{Z}) \rightarrow 0$ form a countable set. For increasing sequences this is due to Erdős and Taylor [10, Theorem 1, p. 600], who obtain it by modifying Eggleston’s proof of his Theorem 16, and Fan proves the form stated here [11, Lemma 3.1, p. 7]. For $g_a = Bh_a$ ($a \geq 1$) the ratios are the integers $b_a \in \{2, 6, 10, 30\}$, and the argument of Proposition 4.5 identifies the set: it consists of the ξ for which $Bh_a \xi$ is eventually an integer. By (6) and Theorem 4.6 it contains S for some B exactly when S is rational. Infinite rank and the modular minors of Corollary 2.2 constrain the kernel, while a scalar argument must also use its exact multiplicities. The long record gives further conditional rigidity statements, but an argument for S must verify their block identities for the actual weighted multiplicities. Neither a finite-dimensional ansatz nor a countability statement does that.

Statements and declarations

Proof sources. The two-prime deduction uses an external transcendence theorem and is not formalised here. The arbitrary-order rank theorem and literal tail bridge have the named Lean sources recorded in the concordance. Two verification tracks must be kept separate: the public repository and the selected Palomar release. The supplied 16 September 2026 inventory records a successful public CI build at commit 99f4bf47422abbd8757cbb22b50ba079d764d3a7. The separate Palomar release at 52f29ad1 selects the arbitrary-order uniform-minor and non-separation theorems themselves, not merely the 2×2 fixture. Its recorded Comparator replay therefore has that broader scope. These are attached verification receipts, not a fresh build performed for this editorial revision, and do not certify every sentence of either paper or the irrationality of S . The elementary modular-minor corollary is proved above. Its older linked module is not among the attached source files, so its current build status is not inferred from the inventory. The exact-denominator corollary and the boundary example added in this revision have ordinary proofs and exact checks, but no new formalisation claim. The required cofinal escape remains unproved.

Artefact and data availability. Each source link is pinned to its own immutable revision. The exact-reference inventory records those revisions and their bitwise comparison with the public source commit recorded in the supplied inventory. The extended reasoning record and the accompanying source retain the detailed shell bounds, finite experiments and alternative representations with their exact hypotheses. Supplied later-source labels and public links remain separate source coordinates.

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A Guide to the formal sources

The mathematical dependency chain is: height identity, kernel rescaling, threshold determinant; and, independently, literal shell forcing, tail recurrence, denominator clearing and residue contradiction. The historical declaration inventory is retained in the long record and the machine-readable source index. The package also includes an exact concordance of the links removed from the main narrative. Moving a link changes its location, not its immutable revision or evidence status.

Statement family	Source and scope
Kernel rank	KernelCarryRank: arbitrary-order uniform minors and no finite rational separation; also selected in the Palomar release.
Literal series	DyadicShellSummability, RationalityCarryBridge: actual summable tails and denominator clearing, not merely an abstract recurrence.
Quadratic bounds	PaperR8RankMajorant and ActualSharpTailMajorantR10: the actual Q bound and the smaller jump-constrained bound recorded in the long paper.
Residue equivalence	CofinalWindowEscapeEquivalence and R12/OcticWindowBand: conditional consumer and exact equivalence, not an unconditional cofinal producer.
External input	Bugeaud–Laurent and Loxton–van der Poorten for the two-prime theorem; no Lean value theorem claimed.

The public inventory supplied for this revision pins commit 99f4bf47422abbd8757cbb22b50ba079d764d3a7, historical hyperlinks in the text retain their own revisions. A source location, a CI build, a selected Comparator statement and an axiom audit are different evidence items. None may stand in for the others without its own receipt.

B Pinned Lean sources

The following declarations are this note’s pin-faithful source inventory. Line numbers are those of the commit named by `\commit`.

- [smooth prefix lcm eq three prime height](#)
- [smooth prefix lcm eq of same log cell](#)
- [smooth prefix lcm first log step](#)
- [smooth prefix lcm second log step](#)

- smooth prefix lcm third log step
- three prime jump set with origin card
- finite smooth kernel sum grouped by height
- dyadic block base235 cases
- dyadic internal power exponent unique
- smooth exponent shell card quadratic
- smooth3 val
- three prime height
- three prime kernel q
- smooth prefix exponents
- smooth prefix lcm
- smooth3 val dvd three prime height of mem
- smooth prefix lcm dvd three prime height
- pure first mem smooth prefix exponents
- pure second mem smooth prefix exponents
- pure third mem smooth prefix exponents
- same three prime log cell
- three prime height eq of same log cell
- three prime kernel q eq of same log cell
- positive prime powers
- positive prime powers card
- one not mem positive prime powers
- positive prime powers disjoint
- three prime positive jump set
- three prime positive jump set card
- three prime jump set with origin
- three prime height first log step
- three prime height second log step
- three prime height third log step
- smooth exponent box
- smooth point height

- smooth height fiber
- smooth height fiber kernel sum
- three prime height le cube
- kernel 235 origin
- kernel 235 two
- kernel 235 three
- kernel 235 six
- kernel 235 not rank one
- tail state step
- tail state step eq
- smooth exponent shell
- exponent unique in short interval
- smooth exponent shell card le drop first
- smooth exponent shell card le drop third
- sorted pair quadratic
- dyadic internal power
- dyadic block base235 mem interval
- least positive residue
- least positive residue pos le
- least positive residue mod eq
- residue escapes window
- no bounded positive state of residue escape
- residue le bound of bounded positive state
- no bounded positive int state of least positive residue
- window base
- window forcing
- affine recurrence window
- window forcing const mul
- integral carry window
- smooth3 val dvd three prime height of le
- integral carry cancel common factor

- reduced carry pos le of common factor
- reduced integral carry window
- cofinal local window escape
- no positive reduced carry of cofinal local window escape
- kernel 235 minor eq neg one fifteen
- least positive residue eq nat abs of pos le mod eq
- bounded radix zero or cofinal far
- least positive residue window forcing eq carry
- carry eq residue digit add coboundary
- cartier realisation
- finite realised span of factorisation
- carry residue mem interval
- residue digit mem interval
- channel block null iff channel potential
- no carry lift of error bound below two pow
- no bounded carry lift of block null two anchors
- binary lift two anchors force first block sum one
- no unit accurate lift with two anchors and first two block null

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